Data Analyst Job Description: Top Duties and Qualifications

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A data analyst, or data business analyst, supports business decision-making by analyzing and summarizing data. In this article, we explore how to build a competitive job description for this role, featuring key duties such as extracting data, creating reports and analyzing key performance indicators.

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Data Analyst: Hiring Fast Facts

Indeed (US) - September 2026

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↘ -12,820 since August 2026

Average Salary

$86,852 / year

Average $86,852

Low $23,000 **High** $190,000

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Data analyst duties and responsibilities

Data analysts collect, interpret and present data to help organizations make informed business decisions. They work with datasets from multiple sources, using tools like spreadsheets and visualization software to find trends and develop insights. Data analysts often collaborate with business leaders to define important metrics and improve data accuracy to support strategic planning.

Common duties include:

- Gathering data from SQL databases, web sources and API integrations
- Filtering data to remove errors and duplicate information
- Transforming data to the format required by analytical tools or company systems

- Applying statistical analysis to data to find patterns and draw conclusions
- Creating visual representations of data to help business professionals understand findings
- Writing reports and giving presentations to communicate data insights

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What does a data analyst do?

Data analysts transform raw information into insights that help guide business strategy and operational decisions. By identifying trends, tracking KPIs and validating data accuracy, they help organizational leaders reduce risk and make evidence-based decisions.

Data analysts often collaborate with marketing teams, finance departments and executives to clarify reporting needs and define measurable goals. They may work closely with marketing managers, operations managers or sales managers to improve forecasting or

resource allocation. For example, a data analyst might gather insight about content performance to help marketing teams design more cost-effective campaigns.

Data analyst skills and qualifications

Strong candidates often demonstrate analytical, problem-solving and computational skills, which often lead to success in this role. Written communication skills and attention to detail are also valuable traits that set quality candidates apart.

Other key skills required for the job may include:

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- Advanced spreadsheet knowledge, including pivot tables and lookups
- Proficiency in SQL for querying relational databases
- Experience with data visualization tools like Looker and Tableau
- Knowledge of statistical analysis methods like control charts
- Ability to validate, clean and transform data
- Familiarity with coding languages like Python
- Understanding of key business metrics and KPI tracking
- Ability to translate business questions into data queries

Data analyst experience requirements

Experience that reflects previous work with data, including SQL queries, advanced spreadsheet design or reporting, is relevant. A skills-first approach can help you discover candidates who have cleaned datasets, tracked performance metrics or presented findings to teams, even if they worked outside of a formal data analyst role.

You might consider candidates with experience in marketing analytics or research. Applicants with operations experience may have data analysis and reporting skills that can transfer to this position.

Data analyst education and training requirements

Data analyst roles are frequently filled by candidates with varied educational backgrounds, especially when they can demonstrate strong technical and analytical skills. You might consider practical

experience with spreadsheets and SQL alongside or instead of a specific degree. Many candidates build these skills through certificate programs, boot camps and self-directed learning.

You may prefer candidates with relevant degrees, such as those in data science, statistics, information systems or business analytics. Certificates, such as Tableau Certified Data Analyst, can demonstrate a candidate's relevant skills.

Data analyst salary expectations

- Common salary: **$86,852 yearly**
- Typical salaries range from **$23,000 - $190,000 yearly**
- Find more information on Indeed Salaries

*Indeed data – September 2026

Job description samples for similar positions

If this data analyst job description sample isn't what you're looking for, consider other sample job descriptions that might align with your needs:

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- Data entry clerk
- Data scientist

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Data analyst job description FAQs

What's the difference between a data analyst and a data scientist?

Data analysts focus on organizing, analyzing and reporting on existing data to help teams track performance and make business decisions. Data scientists build predictive models, develop algorithms and work with larger or more complex datasets to forecast trends and support advanced analytics initiatives.

Who does a data analyst report to?

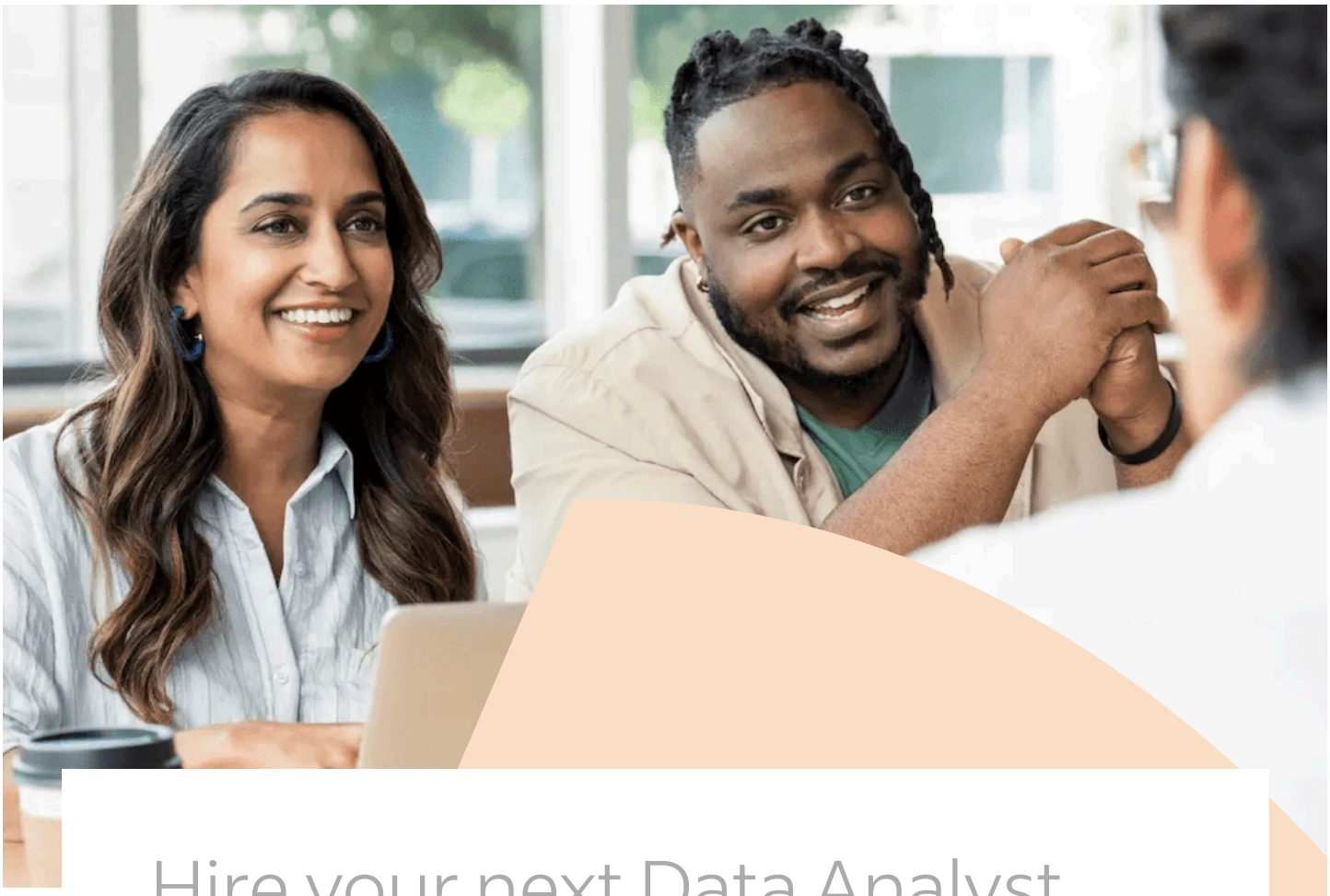
A data analyst typically reports to a manager in operations, finance or marketing, depending on where the position supports in yo organization. In larger companies, they may report to a director of analytics, business intelligence manager or data manager who sets reporting priorities and project goals.

Can a data analyst work remotely?

Yes, many data analysts work remotely because most tasks involve digital tools and virtual collaboration. Remote arrangements often work well when data access, security protocols and communication workflows are clearly defined, though some employers prefer hybrid schedules for team collaboration.

Does a data analyst have supervisory responsibility?

Most data analyst roles do not include direct supervisory responsibility. Analysts typically focus on data reporting, analysis and collaboration with teams. In senior or lead roles, they may guide junior analysts or review work performed by others.



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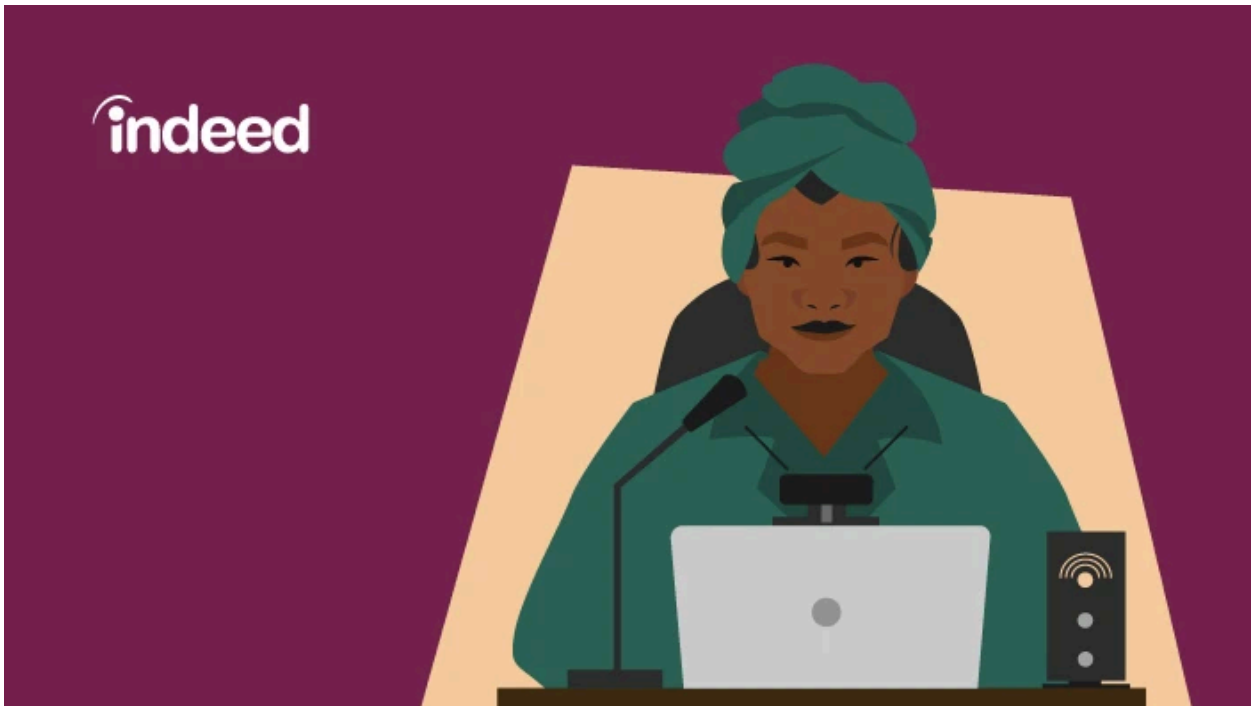
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- Activity Assistant
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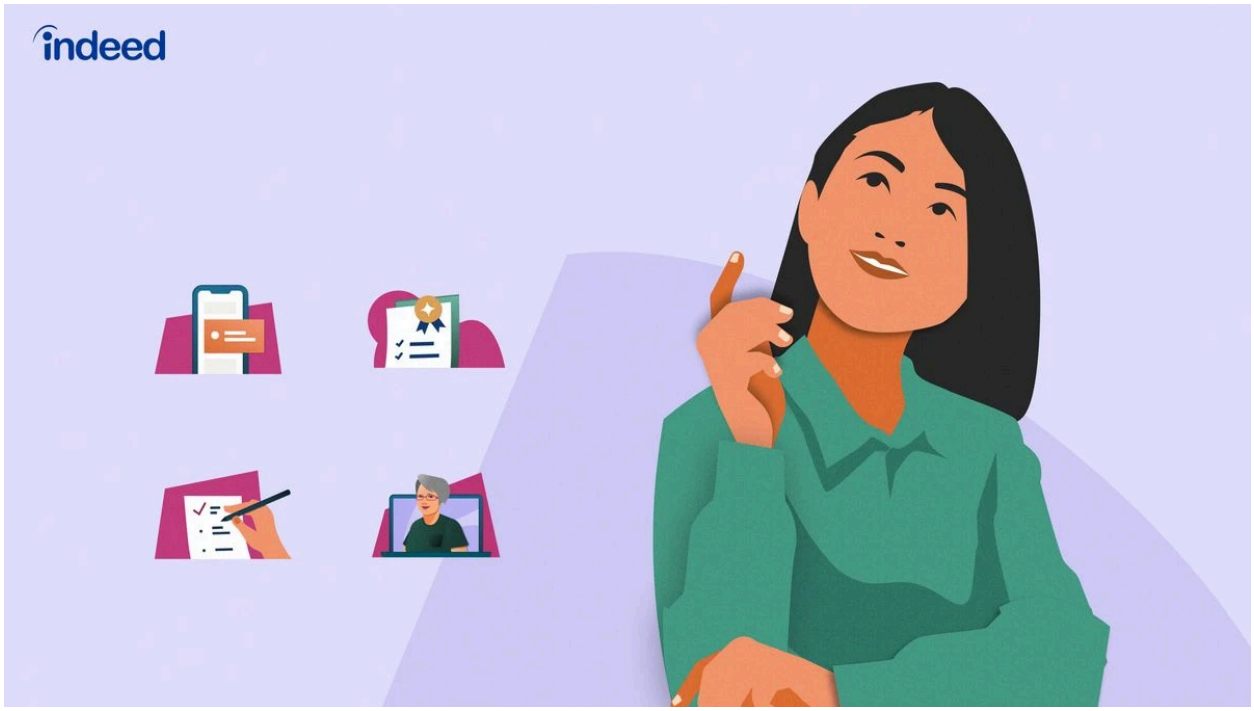
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